Previous year Verbal Ability Paper (Infosys)

MM: 20
Time : 20 Minutes
There is no negative marking

A. Read the each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical error in it. The error, if any will be in one part of the sentence. The letter of that part is the answer. If there is no error, the answer is 'D'. (Ignore the errors of punctuation, if any).

1.(A) We discussed about the problem so thoroughly /(B)on the eve of the examination/(C)that I found it very easy to work it out./ (D)No error.

2.(A) He fell from a running train /(B) and would have died /(C) if the villagers did not get him admitted in the nearby hospital immediately. / (D)No error.

3.(A) He is /(B) too intelligent /(C) to make a mistake. / (D)No error.

4.(A) He was sure /(B) that he should /(C) win the Prize. / (D)No error.

5.(A) I have read /(B) too many books /(C) by R . K . Narayan. / (D)No error.

B. ***In questions given below, a part of the sentence is italicised and underlined. Below are given alternatives to the italicised part which may improve the sentence. Choose the correct alternative. In case no improvement is needed, option 'D' is the answer.***

1) The poor villagers *have waited* in the bitter cold for more than 4 hours now.
   a) have been waiting
   b) had waited
   c) has been waiting
   d) No improvement
2) The old man felled some trees in the garden with *hardly no effort* at all.
   a) hard effort
   b) hardly any effort
   c) a hardly any effort
   d) No improvement
3) The company goes to great length to ensure that employees *can be comfortable* in their work environment.
   a) are comfortable
   b) will be comfortable
   c) should be comfortable
   d) No improvement
4) I want *you to clearly understand* that excuses won't do
   a) you clearly to understand
   b) you to understand clearly
   c) to clearly understand you
   d) No improvement
5) He *was fined* for careless driving.
   a) got fined
   b) fined
   c) was to be fined
   d) No improvement
6) As he is past his teens now, he can look *for* himself.
   a) after
   b) to
   c) around
   d) No improvement
7) *There is no more room* for you in this compartment.
   a) there is no more seat
   b) there is no more space
   c) there is no more accommodation
   d) No improvement
8) Will you *lend me few rupees* in this hour of need?
   a) lend me any rupees
   b) borrow me a few rupees
   c) lend me a few rupees
   d) No improvement
9) During his long discourse, he did not *touch* that point.
   a) touch upon
   b) touch on
   c) touch of
   d) No improvement
10) He found a *wooden broken chair* in the room.
   a) wooden and broken chair
   b) broken wooden chair
   c) broken and wooden chair
   d) No improvement

C. Read the following passage and answer the questions follow:

(This passage was written in 1978.)

Recent years have brought minority- owned businesses in the United States unprecedented opportunities—as well as new and significant risks. Civil rights activists have long argued that one of the principal reasons why Blacks, Hispanics, and other minority groups have difficulty establishing themselves in business is that they lack access to the sizable orders and subcontracts that are generated by large companies. Now Congress, in apparent agreement, has required by law that businesses awarded federal contracts of more than $ 500,000 do their best to find minority subcontractors and record their efforts to do so on forms filed with the government. Indeed, some federal and local agencies have gone so far as to set specific percentage goals for apportioning parts of public works contracts to minority enterprises.

Corporate response appears to have been substantial. According to figures collected in 1977, the total of corporate contracts with minority businesses rose from

$77 million in 1972 to $1.1 billion in 1977. The projected total of corporate contracts with minority businesses for the early 1980's is estimated to be over 53 billion per year with no letup anticipated in the next decade.

Promising as it is for minority businesses, this increased patronage poses dangers for them, too. First, minority firms risk expanding too fast and overextending themselves financially, since most are small concerns and, unlike large businesses, they often need to make substantial investments in new plants, staff, equipment, and the like in order to perform work subcontracted to them. If, thereafter, their subcontracts are for some reason reduced, such firms can face potentially crippling fixed expenses. The world of corporate purchasing can be frustrating for small entrepreneurs who get requests for elaborate formal estimates and bids. Both consume valuable time and resources, and a small company's efforts must soon result in orders, or both the morale and the financial health of the business will suffer.

A second risk is that White-owned companies may seek to cash in on the increasing apportionments through formation of joint ventures with minority- owned concerns. Of course, in many instances there are legitimate reasons for joint ventures; clearly, White and minority enterprises can team upto acquire business that neither could acquire alone. But civil rights groups and minority business owners have complained to Congress about minorities being set up as "fronts" with White backing, rather than being accepted as full partners in legitimate joint ventures.

Third, a minority enterprise that secures the business of one large corporate customer often runs the danger of becoming—and remaining—dependent. Even in the best of circumstances, fierce competition from larger, more established companies makes it difficult for small concerns to broaden their customer bases: when such firms have nearly guaranteed orders from a single corporate benefactor, they may truly have to struggle against complacency arising from their current success.

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

b) present a commonplace idea and its inaccuracies
c) describe a situation and its potential drawbacks
d) propose a temporary solution to a problem
e) analyze a frequent source of disagreement
f) explore the implications of a finding

2) **The passage supplies information that would answer which of the following questions?**

a) What federal agencies have set percentage goals for the use of minority-owned businesses in public works contracts?
b) To which government agencies must businesses awarded federal contracts report their efforts to find minority subcontractors?
c) How widespread is the use of minority-owned concerns as "fronts" by White backers seeking to obtain subcontracts?
d) How many more minority-owned businesses were there in 1977 than in 1972?
e) What is one set of conditions under which a small business might find itself financially overextended?

3) **According to the passage, civil rights activists maintain that one disadvantage under which minority-owned businesses have traditionally had to labor is that they have**

a) been especially vulnerable to governmental mismanagement of the economy
b) been denied bank loans at rates comparable to those afforded larger competitors
c) not had sufficient opportunity to secure business created by large corporations
d) not been able to advertise in those media that reach large numbers of potential customers
e) not had adequate representation in the centers of government power

4) **The passage suggests that the failure of a large business to have its bids for subcontracts result quickly in orders might cause it to**

a) experience frustration but not serious financial harm
b) face potentially crippling fixed expenses
c) have to record its efforts on forms filed with the government
d) increase its spending with minority subcontractors
e) revise its procedure for making bids for federal contracts and subcontracts

5) The author implies that a minority-owned concern that does the greater part of its business with one large corporate customer should

a) avoid competition with larger, more established concerns by not expanding
b) concentrate on securing even more business from that corporation
c) try to expand its customer base to avoid becoming dependent on the corporation
d) pass on some of the work to be done for the corporation to other minority-owned concerns
e) use its influence with the corporation to promote subcontracting with other minority concerns